

Passages - Only Dull People are Brilliant at Breakfast

It would be unfair to expect other people to be as remarkable as oneself.

Life is much too important a thing ever to talk seriously about it.

I have always been of the opinion that consistency is the last refuge of the unimaginative

Unless one is wealthy there is no use in being a charming fellow. Romance is the privilege of the rich, not the profession of the unemployed. The poor should be practical and prosaic. It is better to have a permanent income than to be fascinating.

The only thing that sustains one through life is the consciousness of the immense inferiority of everybody else, and this is a feeling that I have always cultivated.

I am so clever that sometimes I don't understand a single word of what I am saying.

Thinking is the most unhealthy thing in the world, and people die of it just as they die of any other dis-ease. Fortunately, in England at any rate, thought is not catching.

Oscar Wilde

A work of art is the unique result of a unique temperament ... the moment that an artist takes notice of what other people want, and tries to supply the demand, he ceases to be an artist, and becomes a dull or an amusing craftsman, an honest or a dishonest tradesman.

The only thing that can console one for being poor is extravagance. The only thing that can console one for being rich is economy.

The first duty in life is to be as artificial as possible. What the second duty is no one has as yet discovered.

Pleasure is the only thing one should live for.

Nothing ages like happiness.

Only the shallow know themselves.

The aim of love is to love: no more, and no less.

Most people are other people. Their thoughts are someone else's opinions, their lives a mimicry, their passions a quotation.

I never put off till tomorrow what I can possibly do - the day after.

No great artist ever sees things as they really are. IF he did, he would cease to be an artist.

Selfishness is not living as one wishes to live, it is asking others to live as one wishes to live.

It is only the intellectually lost who ever argue.

A sentimentalist is simply a man who desires to have the luxury of an emotion without paying for it.

Fashion is merely a form of ugliness so unbearable that we are compelled to alter

it every six months.

To do nothing at all is the most difficult thing in the world, the most difficult and the most intellectual.

Are there not books that can make us live more in one single hour than life can make us live in a score of shameful years?

I like persons better than principles, and I like persons with no principles better than anything else in the world.